Summary

By now, you've got a secure and efficient system for handling media files in your app on your Linux server. You started by setting up local file storage by tweaking Laravel's filesystem configuration to create a special "media" disk with a secure storage path. You used Linux commands to set the right ownership and permissions, making sure that only the web server could access these files. You also put in place solid file upload and retrieval procedures, checking file types and sizes to stop malicious uploads and prevent people from misusing resources. You also integrated the Intervention Image library to automate image processing tasks like resizing and optimizing images for performance, and you demonstrated secure file streaming and download functionalities by leveraging Laravel's response methods.